



FLASHPOINT

POLESTAR INSIGHTS

REPORTING PERIOD: 21 JULY 2026 - 27 JULY 2026

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Public-order risk this week is about operational tempo rather than a single headline event. It was shaped by strike / labour action, curfew / emergency order and student activism, and India carries the heaviest concentration, with Philippines and South Korea as supporting watch areas. The most serious reached extreme, so this week is not routine.

What stands out is speed: these events move from notice to road closure, transit halt or site-access disruption inside a working day. The pattern is rapid escalation against a standing baseline of unrest, not isolated flare-ups.

For business users the implication is straightforward: protect staff movement, site access and continuity comms against short-notice disruption on the named cities. Refreshed journey-management plans, agreed escalation triggers and live country-lead routing do more work this week than headline-severity tracking.

FAST FACTS

REPORTING PERIOD 21 Jul - 27 Jul 2026	INCIDENTS IN WINDOW 76	HIGHEST SEVERITY Extreme Highest rating this week
TOP ISSUE TYPE Protest 43 incidents	MOST AFFECTED COUNTRY India 40 incidents	LATEST INCIDENT 26 Jul 2026

ACTIVISM AND PROTEST READ

Across 21 Jul - 27 Jul 2026 the activism picture is led by "India's Protest Movement Ends After Minister Quits", which falls in the Low severity band.

Activity is being driven by named opposition mobilisation, sectoral chamber and union action and student and campus activism - several separate organising efforts that are harder for authorities to contain than a single-issue wave and that historically turn into rolling road action within 24-72 hours of an announced date.

The locations to watch are city-centre commercial districts, court complexes, party headquarters, ministry quarters and the main intercity roads. Staff movement, deliveries and customer-facing sites are usually affected first; disruption to suppliers from sectoral walkouts tends to follow a day or so later.

DATE	ISSUE	TITLE	SEVERITY
26 Jul 2026	Protest	DENR denies releasing pesticide gas during QC protest	LOW
26 Jul 2026	Protest	Victims of microfinance exploitation organize protest march in Kathmandu (Photo Feature)	LOW
26 Jul 2026	Protest	UPI cancels July 26 anti-corruption rally in Manila	LOW
26 Jul 2026	Protest	India's Protest Movement Ends After Minister Quits	LOW
26 Jul 2026	Strike / labour action	Fishermen observe one-day strike demanding release of peers arrested by Sri Lanka Navy	MODERATE
26 Jul 2026	Protest	Sri Lanka Latest Breaking News and Headlines - Print Edition Paddy cultivators stage protest in Anuradhapura	LOW
25 Jul 2026	Protest	India's CJP says ending protest after minister resigns	LOW
25 Jul 2026	Protest	South Korea US Iran Protest	LOW
25 Jul 2026	Protest	India's Gen Z are filming 'fit checks' while running from police	LOW
24 Jul 2026	Protest	BRS working president KTR leads BRSV protest in Hyderabad in solidarity with students	LOW
24 Jul 2026	Protest	Malaysia NGOs protest US pressure over Israel policy	LOW
24 Jul 2026	Protest	How Abhijeet Dipke became the face of India's first Gen Z protest movement	LOW

CIVIL UNREST AND PUBLIC ORDER READ

The civil-unrest picture across 21 Jul - 27 Jul 2026 centres on "Indian police fire tear gas at protesters", the most significant event reported.

How the authorities are responding is the key point right now: statutory restrictions are already in play and police have already used force or made arrests at demonstrations. That shortens the time from an announced rally to violence from days to hours and raises the chance that the next protest date draws a tougher response rather than measured policing.

For businesses, the takeaway is that crackdowns, curfew orders and internet shutdowns matter more than the number of protests: they show where staff movement, commercial operations and venue access can be disrupted at short notice. Where enforcement clusters around a single city or district, expect road closures, patchy connectivity and same-day venue access restrictions.

DATE	ISSUE	TITLE	SEVERITY
24 Jul 2026	Curfew / emergency order	Thailand Declares Martial Law After Narathiwat Attack	EXTREME
21 Jul 2026	Crackdown	Indian police fire tear gas at protesters	HIGH

FORECAST: NEXT 7-14 DAYS

COUNTRY	SIGNAL	OPERATIONAL MEANING
Philippines	Civic protest march (Manila)	Confirm details, expected turnout and operating impact inside 24-48h.
Malaysia	Civic protest march	Confirm details, expected turnout and operating impact inside 24-48h.
India	Civic protest march	Confirm details, expected turnout and operating impact inside 24-48h.
Bangladesh	Civic protest march	Confirm details, expected turnout and operating impact inside 24-48h.
Philippines	Sectoral strike notice (Manila)	Supply disruption and sectoral closures 24-72h ahead.

Confirmed upcoming events are listed in the table above and are the first things to plan around for the next 7-14 days. The outlook below builds on that schedule.

Two different stories sit side by side here and should be read together. By volume, India sees the most activity and is the most likely source of repeated, lower-level disruption. For seriousness, the sharper concern is Thailand, where Thailand Declares Martial Law After Narathiwat rated Extreme - less frequent but with more potential to escalate. More events is not the same as more dangerous ones: plan for widespread disruption across India and for sharper escalation in Thailand.

Protest activity dominates at the moment, so the most likely escalation path is from announced rallies and trade-group walkouts into intermittent road closures and city-centre disruption. Risk increases if security forces respond with mass arrests, tear gas or curfew orders; risk eases if organisers stand down voluntarily or political talks open.

A note of caution: this outlook is based on one reporting period and confirmed announcements, so treat it as a starting point rather than a firm prediction. Conditions can change quickly around court rulings, policy decisions and announced protest dates.

REGIONAL AND COUNTRY VIEW

This week activity spans South Asia (led by India), East Asia (led by South Korea), Southeast Asia (led by Philippines) and Pacific (led by Australia). The incidents are separate and driven by different local issues rather than a shared regional campaign; India recorded the most events, but businesses with a presence in several APAC capitals should plan around each country's own protest calendar rather than a single regional trend.

India - The busiest area this week, driven by protest activity and other operational incidents. Likely form: announced rallies and sectoral walkouts that routinely draw a visible enforcement response; main areas affected: city-centre commercial districts, government precincts and university campuses.

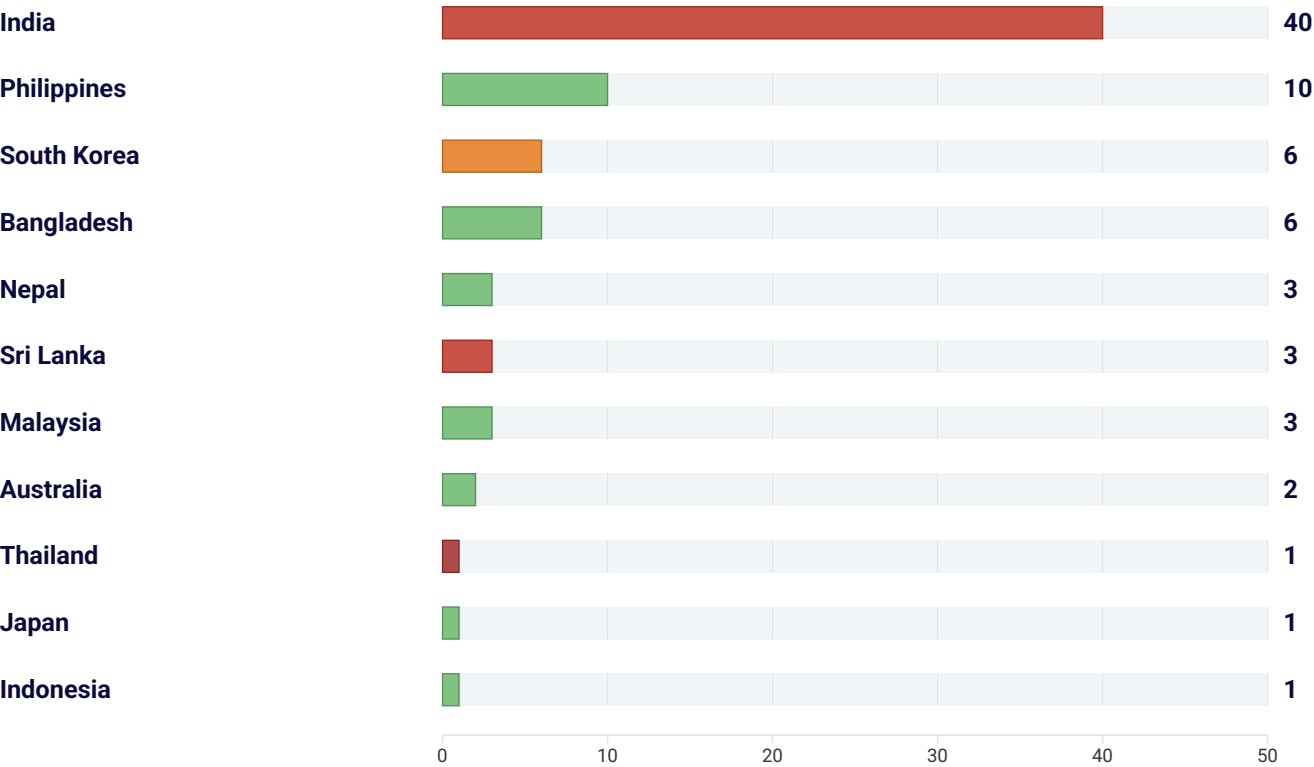
Philippines - The second-busiest area this week, driven by protest activity and other operational incidents. Likely form: announced rallies, sectoral walkouts and student-body actions converting into road closures; main areas affected: wholesale markets, transport corridors and sectoral premises (pharmacies, courts, hauliers).

South Korea - The third-busiest area this week, driven by strike and labour action and protest activity. Likely form: announced rallies, sectoral walkouts and student-body actions converting into road closures; main areas affected: wholesale markets, transport corridors and sectoral premises (pharmacies, courts, hauliers).

Other APAC countries saw less activity this week and appear in the country chart below.

INCIDENTS BY COUNTRY

Bar length shows incident count; colour shows the highest severity reported in each country.



WHAT MATTERS

These events move quickly from notice to disruption, putting staff movement, site access and business continuity under real-time pressure. Concentration in India, Philippines and South Korea carries the operational weight.

What matters most this week is that activity is spread across South Asia, East Asia, Southeast Asia and Pacific rather than concentrated in a single capital. That kind of spread is harder to police, harder to predict and routinely turns into rolling, short-notice disruption across several countries in the same week. India sets the pace but is not the whole picture.

Protest activity and civil unrest running side by side is the classic pattern when announced rallies are routinely met with police orders, selective arrests and tear gas. The bigger risk sits in what follows: curfews, internet shutdowns and mass arrests usually come after a single high-profile incident rather than building slowly.

IMPLICATIONS FOR BUSINESS

- Review staff movement plans and journey-management routings across India and the wider South Asia, East Asia, Southeast Asia and Pacific region against the live protest calendar.
- Set clear work-from-home or delayed-start triggers for offices, plants and customer-facing sites in affected cities.
- Confirm alternative routes for staff, visitors and delivery movements around courts, ministries, campuses and party offices.
- Harden site access controls, perimeter checks and visitor restrictions; pre-position guard reinforcement.
- Pre-approve staff, customer and regulator communications for disruption days so messages move in minutes, not hours.
- Treat any fresh Section 144 / curfew imposition in a city of operation as an immediate WFH trigger and same-day site-closure decision.
- Wire procurement, distribution and customer-service into the security early-warning feed - the trade-group and union walkouts already reported routinely run 24-72 hours ahead of supply disruption.

WATCH NEXT

- Philippines - Civic protest march (Manila): road closures and venue-access friction; brief drivers in advance.
- Malaysia - Civic protest march: road closures and venue-access friction; brief drivers in advance.
- India - Civic protest march: road closures and venue-access friction; brief drivers in advance.
- Bangladesh - Civic protest march: road closures and venue-access friction; brief drivers in advance.
- Philippines - Sectoral strike notice (Manila): supply disruption and sectoral closures 24-72h ahead.

- India - the next dated opposition, trade-group or court call. As the busiest area this week, a fresh trigger here turns fastest into road closures and venue-access problems.

POLESTAR VIEW

Operational tempo, not headline severity, is the picture this week. India remains the city-by-city focus.

Polestar's view: several separate organising efforts are running at the same time as visible enforcement by the authorities. Plan the coming week around further short-notice disruption rather than a return to quiet.

Business disruption risk is moderate: short-notice transport disruption on protest days, closures of public-facing sites driven by Section 144 / curfew orders, and supply disruption from trade-group walkouts. The main remaining risk is an announced protest or strike date that draws larger crowds than this week's actions.

RELATED INCIDENTS

DATE	ISSUE	TITLE	SEVERITY
26 Jul 2026	Protest	India's Protest Movement Ends After Minister Quits	LOW
24 Jul 2026	Curfew / emergency order	Thailand Declares Martial Law After Narathiwat Attack	EXTREME
26 Jul 2026	Strike / labour action	Fishermen observe one-day strike demanding release of peers arrested by Sri Lanka Navy	MODERATE
23 Jul 2026	Strike / labour action	Hyundai Motor union extends strike, plans three-day walkout in South Korea	MODERATE
26 Jul 2026	Protest	DENR denies releasing pesticide gas during QC protest	LOW
26 Jul 2026	Protest	Victims of microfinance exploitation organize protest march in Kathmandu (Photo Feature)	LOW

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